

Hardship Assistance / Financial Crisis Timeline

Overview

This timeline documents my hardship assistance request, Respondent's knowledge of my emergency financial, medical, and housing crisis, the delay in approval/payment, and the resulting damages.

This hardship did not occur in isolation. At the time I requested assistance, I was already losing income because I was using intermittent FMLA for a condition my doctor connected to workplace environmental/interpersonal issues and reported discrimination. Although I was a salaried employee, when I used intermittent FMLA for partial-day absences, I was not paid for the FMLA hours. This reduced my income during the same period I was dealing with severe medical expenses, rent arrears, and housing instability.

The chain of harm was:

Workplace discrimination/retaliation → worsening medical/mental health symptoms → intermittent FMLA → unpaid FMLA hours/reduced income → hardship request → delayed assistance → eviction/housing harm.

I initiated the hardship assistance request on **November 13, 2025**. I submitted the hardship ticket and completed the required attestation the same day. My request was approximately **\$4,950**, which was over the \$1,000 attestation threshold but below the \$5,000 exception-only threshold in Respondent's hardship policy.

Respondent was aware of the request immediately. That same morning, a meeting titled "**SH Hardship**" appeared on Allan Glover's calendar involving **Susan Marchinko**, **Allan Glover**, and **Greg Carfagna**. Later that same day, **Cameron Hadley**, Lead Employee Relations Consultant, contacted me to schedule a meeting about my hardship request.

Despite this early notice, and despite me providing requested documentation after my November 17 meeting with Cameron, the hardship funds were not received until approximately **December 5, 2025**, around the date of my eviction or immediately after the eviction-related harm occurred.

Hardship Policy Background

Respondent's Employee Hardship Assistance Program states that assistance may be available when employees experience personal or economic hardship outside of their control that results in unmet financial needs.

The policy states that requests are reviewed case-by-case based on the program guidelines and the employee's individual circumstances. The policy also states that Respondent may require evidence from the employee for further consideration.

For requests over **\$1,000**, the policy requires the employee to complete an attestation form indicating they have exhausted other avenues for financial assistance. I completed this attestation.

For requests over **\$5,000**, the policy states that approval is only available on an exception basis for extenuating circumstances. My request was approximately **\$4,950**, which was below the \$5,000 exception-only threshold.

The policy also states that once complete documentation is received, funds are processed twice weekly:

Complete Documentation Received By	Employee Receives Funds By
Monday at 12:00pm Central	Wednesday
Wednesday at 12:00pm Central	Friday

Why this matters:

The policy provides the standard for evaluating whether my hardship request was handled consistently and timely. My request was below the \$5,000 exception-only threshold, and I completed the required attestation. Respondent should explain why additional documentation was required, whether those requirements were applied consistently, when my request was considered complete, and why funds were not received until after or at the point of eviction-related harm.

Pre-Hardship Context: Reduced Income From Workplace-Related Intermittent FMLA

Before and during the hardship request, I was using intermittent FMLA for a condition my doctor connected to workplace environmental/interpersonal issues and reported discrimination.

Although I was a salaried employee, I was not paid for the intermittent FMLA hours I used. For example, if I worked part of a day and used intermittent FMLA for the remainder of the day, I was paid only for the hours worked and not for the FMLA hours.

This is important because the hardship request was not caused by unrelated financial mismanagement. It arose while I was losing income due to intermittent FMLA absences connected to workplace-related symptoms. The unpaid FMLA hours reduced my income at the same time I was experiencing medical expenses, rent late fees, and housing instability.

Why this matters:

The hardship delay should be viewed in context. Respondent's alleged discrimination/retaliation contributed to the medical condition requiring intermittent FMLA. The intermittent FMLA reduced my pay. The reduced pay contributed to my hardship request. The delayed hardship assistance then compounded the financial harm and contributed to the eviction-related outcome.

November 13, 2025 — Initial Hardship Request Submitted

On **November 13, 2025**, I submitted a hardship assistance request/ticket through Respondent's process.

That same day, I completed the required hardship attestation for requests over **\$1,000**.

My hardship request was approximately **\$4,950**, which was above the \$1,000 attestation threshold but below the \$5,000 exception-only threshold.

Why this matters:

This establishes the start date of my hardship request and shows Respondent had formal notice of the hardship request on November 13.

November 13, 2025 — “SH Hardship” Meeting Appears on Allan Glover’s Calendar

On the morning of **November 13, 2025**, after I submitted the hardship request, I observed a meeting on Allan Glover’s calendar titled “**SH Hardship.**”

The meeting appeared to involve:

- **Susan Marchinko**, HR Manager, Involved in Rosanna 2024 incident and EEOC related investigation.
- **Allan Glover**, Ops/ Dept Manager
- **Greg Carfagna**, Director

November 13, 2025 — Cameron Hadley Contacts Me From Employee Relations

Later on **November 13, 2025**, **Cameron Hadley**, Lead Employee Relations Consultant, emailed me to schedule time to discuss my hardship request.

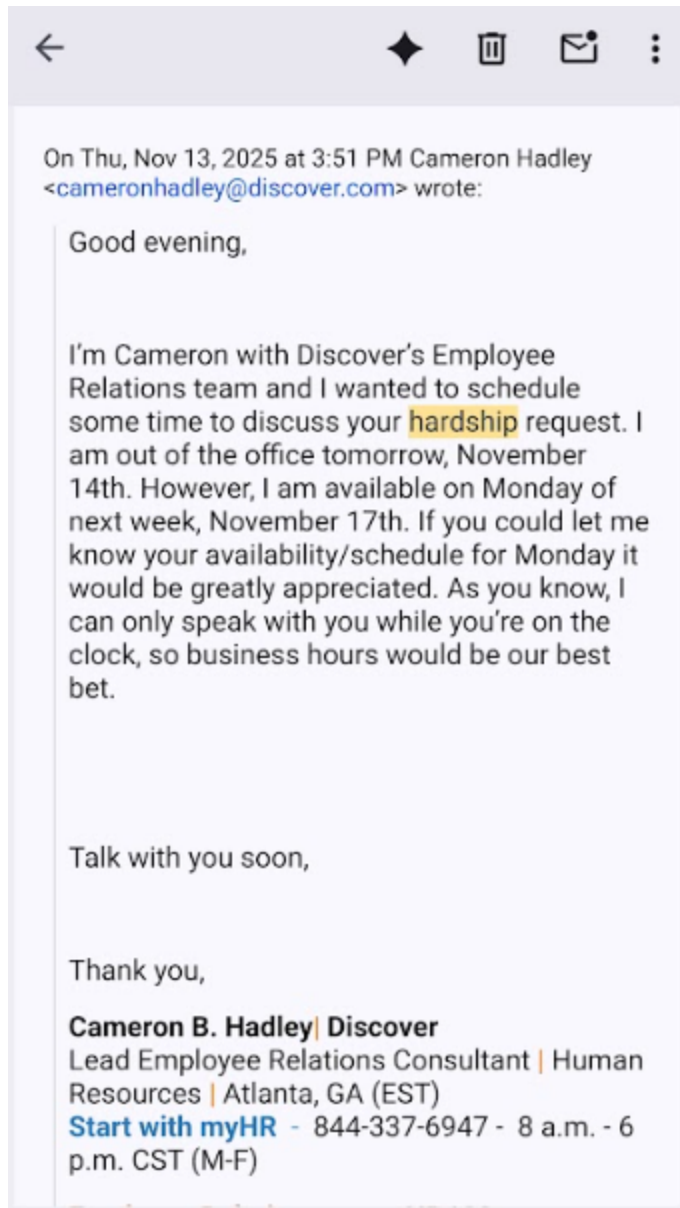
His email stated:

“I’m Cameron with Discover’s Employee Relations team and I wanted to schedule some time to discuss your hardship request.”

He stated he was out of the office on November 14 and asked for my availability on **Monday, November 17, 2025**. He also stated that he could only speak with me while I was on the clock.

Why this matters:

This confirms that Employee Relations was actively involved in my hardship request on the same day I submitted it.



November 17, 2025 — Meeting With Cameron Hadley / Documentation Requirements Discussed

On **November 17, 2025**, I spoke with **Cameron Hadley** regarding my hardship request.

During this conversation, Cameron explained that additional documentation was needed before the request could be considered for approval.

He requested information related to:

- late rent,
- bills,
- a receipt showing I had paid over **\$2,000** for treatment,
- and a police report related to a vehicle break-in/theft involving stolen credit cards, cards, watches, and other property.

When I asked whether the hardship request would be submitted without the information, Cameron stated that he could not submit it without the documentation because the information was needed for the request to be considered.

He also stated that the amount requested was approximately **\$4,950**, which was over \$1,000 and required additional documentation.

I explained that I was under significant stress and was trying to gather the documentation as quickly as possible.

Why this matters:

This shows that even though the hardship request was initiated on November 13 and escalated to HR/leadership that same day, it was still in a documentation/review stage on November 17.

Participants

- **Shawna Harbin** — Employee requesting hardship assistance
 - **Cameron Hadley** — Lead Employee Relations Consultant / HR
-

Hardship Request Status / Documentation Needed

Cameron Hadley:

So when do you think you'll be able to send the information?

Shawna Harbin:

Here, like in the next five minutes.

Cameron Hadley:

Okay. That works. So yeah, let me do that and then I'll review it. If I need anything else, I'll go back with you later this afternoon. If not, either way, I'll communicate with you within the next couple of days, and we'll go from there, okay?

Shawwna Harbin:

You said in the next couple of days. Do you know how long it normally takes?

Cameron Hadley:

I'm here to really just gather all the information that's needed for the approval. I can't say, but like I said, the sooner you get it to me, the sooner I can submit it. It really just depends on how soon you send me that information, and I can send it right over, and then we'll go from there.

Required Documentation

Shawwna Harbin:

Okay, so in order for you to submit it, what is required?

Cameron Hadley:

I need the information on the two late months for the rent and your bills. I need that receipt that you sent that you paid over \$2,000 for this treatment, and then also that police report that you were referring to about those horrible individuals that broke into your vehicle, stole all your credit cards, cards, watches, and things that I mentioned.

Shawwna Harbin:

Okay. And without this information, you will not submit the hardship request?

Cameron Hadley:

No, yeah, I can't. This is the information that's needed in order for it to be considered to be approved. So I need all of that information in order for them to consider that.

Now, if you don't have that information, I can't say whether they still will approve it or not, but it can make it a smoother transition for you.

Shawwna Harbin:

Yes, I guess I'm just trying to understand, like, is it submitted? Because I thought the ticket—

Cameron Hadley:

Right. The information is needed for it to be approved or not. Do you see what I'm saying? For them to consider it to be approved.

Shawwna Harbin:

Oh, okay. So this is like a review stage or something, basically.

Cameron Hadley:

Correct.

Shawwna Harbin:

Oh, okay. That makes sense. I'm just trying to figure out how fast I can get all of this.

Cameron Hadley:

Yeah, this is just the stage of, "Hey, trying to put the request in." The amount is **\$4,950**. That's over the \$1,000 that requires us to have that.

Concern About Documentation Requirements

Shawwna Harbin:

Okay, but what I don't understand is the lady I spoke with, she requested like \$8,000 or something. I don't even know what it was. It was something crazy.

Cameron Hadley:

Again, that situation I can't really speak to because I'm not—

Shawwna Harbin:

It's just so crazy because in that letter, I—well, it's really convenient that literally—okay, whatever. I don't even care. I'm going to get this information. Sorry, I'm just under a lot of stress.

Cameron Hadley:

No, I understand.

Shawwna Harbin:

No, you really don't. But it's okay.

Cameron Hadley:

I understand, like—

Shawwna Harbin:

No, I'm not saying that in your situation right now, but—

Cameron Hadley:

I can say, Shawwna, that we do go through hard times and hardships and different things like that. So I am here trying to get all the information that I can so it will be considered to be approved for you. Again, I can't make any promises.

Shawwna Harbin:

I just think it's funny that you guys are requiring that of only me, or that I know of.

Cameron Hadley:

Like I said, it's not—

Shawna Harbin:

No, it's fine. It's fine. I'm just under so much stress already. I just have so much stuff to do. I don't know. Sorry, I'm just really tired.

Cameron Hadley:

No, it's okay.

Shawna Harbin:

I'm sorry. I'm not even really stressed out about this. I mean, I am, but I'm just tired.

Closing

Cameron Hadley:

As soon as you get that information to me, we'll go from there. I'm going to document everything that we discussed so far, so I have a better understanding of what the place is.

Shawna Harbin:

Yeah, I'm going to get everything right now.

November 17, 2025 — Documentation Submitted

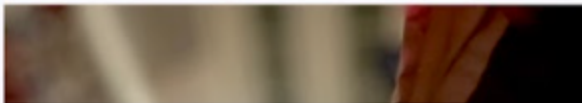
After the November 17 conversation, I provided the requested documentation the same day or very shortly thereafter.

The documentation included information related to:

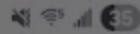
- rent and late fees,
- bills,
- medical expenses,
- treatment receipts,
- and the police report.

Why this matters:

Respondent's hardship policy states that once complete documentation is received, approved funds are processed twice weekly. If complete documentation was received by Monday at

[illegible][illegible]

11:39



Current balance Account # 188193947193



Past due, pay immediately:

\$344.05



Please pay your past due amount to avoid service interruptions.



AutoPay has been paused until your next bill period.

Make a payment

Introducing SplitPay

With SplitPay, the other users on your account can pay for their share of the bill including other lines / devices



← Reply

→ Forward



11:39



Current Balance: \$4,390.39



11/17/2025



Monthly Rent

bucsenlandng.securecave.com

\$6.00

10/1/2025

Late Fees

\$50.00

10/4/2025

Attorney or Legal Charges

\$25.00

10/5/2025

Late Fees

\$270.00

10/31/2025

Monthly Rent

\$1,795.00

11/1/2025

Schedule a Tour

Prices / Availability

← Reply

→ Forward



On or about **November 24, 2025**, my short-term disability request was received for time away from work beginning in November 2025.

At this point, my pay and leave status remained unresolved. I was already experiencing reduced income from intermittent FMLA use and was now seeking short-term disability because my condition had worsened.

Why this matters:

The hardship request remained unresolved while my leave/pay situation was also unresolved. This compounded my financial instability.

November 26, 2025 — Urgent Email to Lindsay Beck Regarding Housing Loss

On **November 26, 2025**, I emailed **Lindsay Beck** regarding my hardship request.

I explained that Monday was the final day I could reclaim my home and that without the funds, my child and I could be permanently without housing.

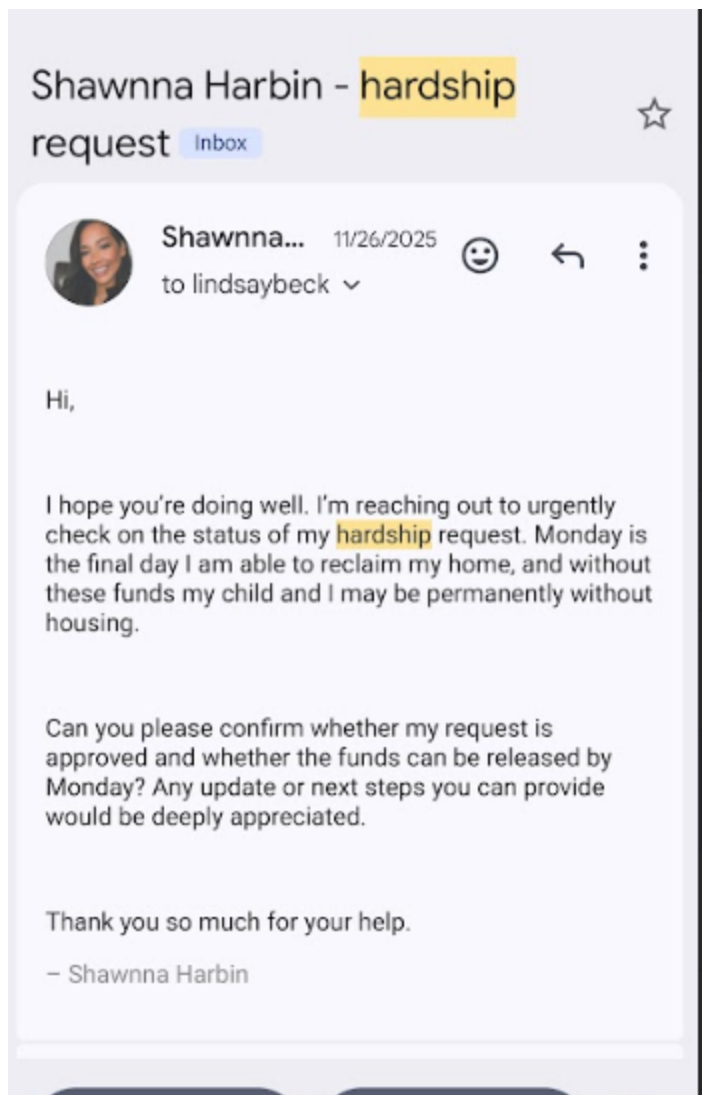
I wrote:

“Monday is the final day I am able to reclaim my home, and without these funds my child and I may be permanently without housing.”

I asked whether my request had been approved and whether the funds could be released by Monday.

Why this matters:

This gave HR direct written notice that my child and I were facing imminent housing loss.



November 26, 2025 — Lindsay Beck Confirms Delay and Capital One Review

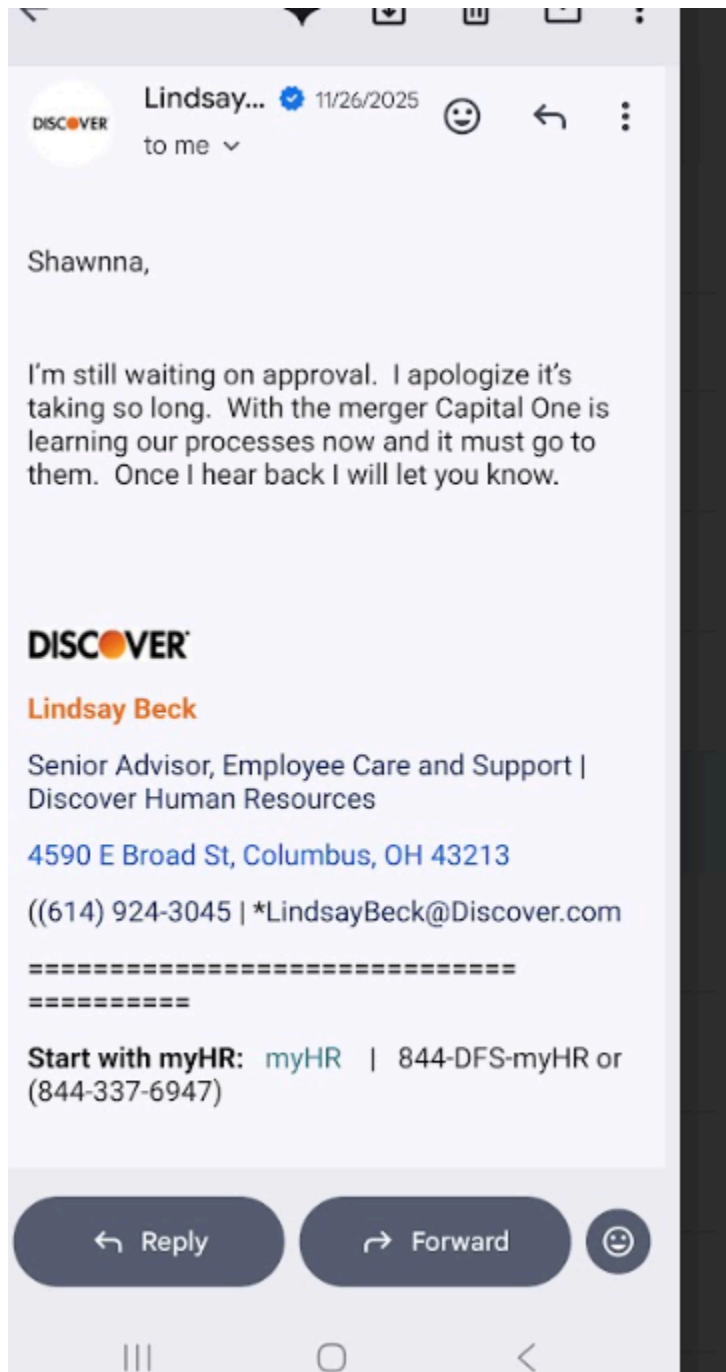
On **November 26, 2025**, Lindsay Beck responded and stated that she was still waiting on approval.

She wrote:

"I'm still waiting on approval. I apologize it's taking so long. With the merger Capital One is learning our processes now and it must go to them. Once I hear back I will let you know."

Why this matters:

This confirms that the hardship request was still not approved almost two weeks after it was initiated and after I had submitted the requested documentation. It also confirms that Capital One/merger-related review was part of the process and delay.



November 28, 2025 — Follow-Up Email Explaining Rent and Medical Urgency

On **November 28, 2025**, I followed up again with Lindsay Beck.

I explained that I was in a very time-sensitive situation involving rent and medical costs and that I was hoping for approval as soon as possible.

Why this matters:

This reinforces that HR had repeated notice of the urgent housing and medical crisis.



December 1, 2025 — Urgent Escalation Before Eviction Hearing

On **December 1, 2025**, I emailed **Lindsay Beck, Allan Glover, Dea Palmer, Susan Marcinko, and Tracy Hedrick** regarding my hardship request.

I explained that I had an eviction hearing that day at **11:00 a.m. MT** and that the judge had specifically requested an update from my employer regarding whether the hardship would be approved so I could return to my home.

I also explained that my son and I had been staying in my car for the past week while the hardship request was pending. I stated that I had already provided everything requested, including the police report and documentation of the expenses and circumstances that led to the situation, and that it had been about two weeks since I submitted the information.

I asked whether a decision had been made and, if not, whether there was any way to expedite a decision or provide a written status update for the court.

Why this matters:

This email gave Respondent direct written notice that my son and I were experiencing emergency housing instability, that we had been staying in my car, and that the hardship decision was needed for an eviction hearing that same day. It also shows I had already submitted the requested documentation approximately two weeks earlier.

 Urgent: Hardship Status Update Needed Before 11:00 a.m. MT 7 messages Shawwna Harbin <atlasom421@gmail.com> To: Lindsay Beck <lindsaybeck@discover.com>, Allan Glover <ALLAnglover@discover.com>, deapalmer@discover.com, susanmarcinko@discover.com, tacyhedrick@discover.com Mon, Dec 1, 2025 at 8:55 AM Hi Lindsay, I hope you're doing well. I'm writing to urgently follow up on the status of my hardship request. I have an eviction hearing today at 11:00 a.m. MT, and the judge has specifically requested an update from my employer on whether the hardship will be approved so that I can return to my home. As of now, my son and I have been staying in my car for the past week while this is pending. I've provided everything that was requested, including my police report and documentation of the expenses and circumstances that led to this situation. It has now been about two weeks since I submitted the information. I've been told (though I don't know if this is accurate) that other employees have received hardship approval in about four days and in some cases without submitting the level of documentation I've provided. If that's not correct, I completely understand, but from my perspective it's very hard to reconcile why my case is still unresolved despite everything I've submitted and the severity of my situation. Can you please let me know: 1. Whether a decision has been made on my hardship request, and 2. If not, whether there is any way to expedite a decision or provide a written status update that I can present to the judge at my 11:00 a.m. hearing? I appreciate any help you can provide and understand that processes take time, but I am truly at an emergency point and need to be able to show the court that my employer is actively working on this. Thank you very much for your time and support, Shawwna Harbin 520-551-1113	550 5.1.1 User: Unknown Lindsay Beck <lindsaybeck@discover.com> To: Shawwna Harbin <atlasom421@gmail.com> Mon, Dec 1, 2025 at 12:12 PM Shawwna, I was able to get the approval. I will be sending it over to payroll. It should pay out by Friday of this week.  Lindsay Beck Senior Advisor, Employee Care and Support Discover Human Resources 4590 E Broad St, Columbus, OH 43213 (614) 924-3045 *LindsayBeck@Discover.com ===== Start with myHR: myHR 844-DFS-myHR or (844-337-6947) Internal From: Shawwna Harbin <atlasom421@gmail.com> Sent: Monday, December 1, 2025 10:56 AM To: Lindsay Beck <lindsaybeck@discover.com>; Allan Glover <allanglover@discover.com>; Dea Palmer <deapalmer@discover.com>; Susan Marcinko <susanmarcinko@discover.com>; tacyhedrick@discover.com Subject: [EXTERNAL] Urgent: Hardship Status Update Needed Before 11:00 a.m. MT
Mail Delivery Subsystem <mailer-daemon@googlemail.com> To: atlasom421@gmail.com Mon, Dec 1, 2025 at 8:56 AM  Address not found Your message wasn't delivered to tacyhedrick@discover.com because the address couldn't be found, or is unable to receive mail. The response from the remote server was:	CAUTION EXTERNAL EMAIL. DO NOT open attachments or click on links from unknown senders or unexpected emails. [Quoted text hidden] Shawwna Harbin <atlasom421@gmail.com> To: Lindsay Beck <lindsaybeck@discover.com> Mon, Dec 1, 2025 at 1:22 PM Hi Lindsay, Thank you so much for the update and for getting this approved. I really appreciate your help.

December 1, 2025 — Eviction / Housing Loss Occurred

On **December 1**, I was evicted. By this point:

- the hardship request had been initiated on November 13,
- HR/leadership had notice,
- Cameron Hadley had contacted me,
- I had met with Cameron,
- I had provided the requested documentation,
- I had followed up with Lindsay Beck,
- and I had warned HR that my child and I could be without housing.

Why this matters:

The housing harm occurred after Respondent had actual notice of the emergency and after I had provided the requested documentation.

Evidence:

Eviction records, court records, lockout notice, rent ledger, hardship emails.

December 3, 2025 — STD/Leave Still Pending

On **December 3, 2025**, Hartford issued an STD/Leave Introduction Letter stating that my request for time away from work had been received on **November 24, 2025** and that my short-term disability claim was still under review.

The letter indicated that Hartford was still reviewing the claim and had not made a decision regarding payment.

Why this matters:

My hardship request was still unresolved during the same period my STD/pay was also unresolved, worsening my financial instability.

Approximately December 5, 2025 — Hardship Funds Received Too Late

I believe I received the hardship funds on or around **December 5, 2025**, either the day I was evicted or the day after.

This means the funds were not received until approximately **22 days after my initial November 13 hardship request** and approximately **18 days after my November 17 documentation submission**.

Respondent's hardship policy reflected a much faster timeline once complete documentation was received.

Why this matters:

The hardship funds arrived too late to prevent the eviction-related harm. Respondent had direct notice of the emergency, requested documentation, received the documentation, and still did not provide funds until after or at the point of eviction-related harm.